the strong level of cultural militarization present in Myanmar, discussed in further detail in the following section.

THE NCA AND LANDMINE USE

On 15 October 2015, the president of Myanmar and representatives of eight EAGs signed the NCA.[7] The negotiations resulted in the inclusion of landmines under the agreement's Chapter Three, on ceasefire-related matters (NCA 2015). The first aspect of the agreement relates to a cessation on laying new mines, and the second outlines the need to undertake demining activities.[8]

Despite these positive steps, there is no broad consensus on how to address the issue of landmines in the country (Cathcart 2015). The language in bilateral ceasefire agreements differs from one to the next, and furthermore, the language used in deeds of commitment, while related, is not intended to reflect and nor does it reflect that of bilateral ceasefires. While reaffirming bilateral ceasefires, the relationship of existing bilateral ceasefires to the NCA is yet to be clarified. Nevertheless, it is clear that the NCA is a significant step towards a ban on the use of landmines in Myanmar.

LANDMINES IN MYANMAR'S COMMUNITY SPACES AND INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

After the military takeover of government in 1962, armed conflict in Myanmar moved into borderland areas. The presupposition that "the best way to destroy rebel groups is to destroy the ability of civilians to support them" (Delang cited in Callahan 2003, p. 208), drove the "four cuts" strategy the army adopted: cutting food, funds, intelligence, and recruits from the enemy (Smith 1991, pp. 258–62). During this time, landmines began to appear on village paths, at water source points, in rice storage, and houses, contributing to displacement and chronic emergency conditions for populations living in these areas.[9] Casualties due to landmines increased. In a study on rights indicators and health outcomes, Mullan et al. (2007) show that displaced communities were five times more likely to have an accident with landmines than if they had not been uprooted by conflict.

After the second military takeover in 1988, landmine use became